

1. What is Spring Data JPA?

It is a Spring module that simplifies database access using JPA by reducing boilerplate code via repositories.

2. Difference between JPA and Hibernate

JPA is a specification, Hibernate is its implementation.

3. What is an Entity in JPA?

A POJO class mapped to a database table using @Entity annotation.

4. Hibernate Session vs EntityManager

Session is Hibernate-specific, EntityManager is JPA standard.

5. Persistence Context

It is a cache that manages entity lifecycle and tracks changes.

6. save() vs saveAndFlush()

save() persists later, saveAndFlush() immediately writes to DB.

7. ID generation strategies

AUTO, IDENTITY, SEQUENCE, TABLE.

8. @Transactional

Manages transaction boundaries and ensures atomic operations.

9. Dirty Checking

Automatically updates DB when entity state changes.

10. First-level cache

Default cache in persistence context per session.

11. LAZY vs EAGER

LAZY loads on demand, EAGER loads immediately.

12. N+1 Problem

Multiple queries issue; solved using fetch joins or EntityGraph.

13. Cascade types

Defines propagation like PERSIST, MERGE, REMOVE.

14. mappedBy vs @JoinColumn

mappedBy defines inverse side, @JoinColumn defines owner.

15. orphanRemoval

Deletes child when removed from parent.

16. JPQL vs Native Query

JPQL uses entity model, native uses SQL.

17. Criteria API

Type-safe dynamic query building.

18. Pagination & Sorting

Handled via Pageable interface.

19. Projections

Fetch partial data using DTO or interface.

20. Complex joins

Use JPQL or native queries.

21. Optimistic vs Pessimistic locking

Optimistic uses versioning, pessimistic locks DB rows.

22. @Version

Used for optimistic locking.

23. Transaction handling

Managed via proxies and AOP.

24. Flushing

Syncs persistence context with DB.

25. get() vs load()

get() hits DB immediately, load() uses proxy.

26. Improve performance

Use caching, batching, indexing.

27. Debug slow queries

Enable SQL logs and analyze execution plans.

28. Large data handling

Use batch processing and pagination.

29. Real issues

N+1, lazy loading exceptions, performance.

30. Relationship design

Prefer unidirectional, avoid deep nesting.